

'TEMPLE OF THE GODS'

There was a shudder in the void: the World's first breath. Swirlings and currents whirled into vortices, whence came forth the winds! each took a name and direction for all eternity. As the winds carved their paths, denser substance was formed, the stuff of all matter. From no-light and no-dark came darkness and light. The dark engendered Knowledge. The light gave rise to will. Breath entered substance as beings were born. At the heart of Creation stands a Temple, its foundations unfathomable! its roof all the stars of Heaven. Six pure white pillars encircle a seventh: a vibrant golden spindle, endlessly turning.

A whisper and a murmur fill the air. The pillars stir, take form. A voice speaks:

"Dark, dark are the fields of Space. They are my kingdom. Utterly limitless: infinite. In time, all men come before my throne. I do not pass judgement: men judge themselves." Opposite him, the Lady of the fields of Space. I too see all who pass through the realm of the fields of Space. There is no need for fear: in death there is life; in life, death. But that which has true value never dies."

The Lord of Light does not speak. He blazes with Light, illuminating all Creation. He is the ineffable source of even the brightest suns.

The Lady of Light rules the moon, mirrors, reflections. She shines in moonbeams, starlight, rainbows, candle-flame. She shifts and changes, while her Lord maintains constancy. Grey-cloaked and long-bearded is the Lord of the Waters of Life. He has dominion over all living waters. He carves out their paths, he sets their course, from mountain stream, through rivers, down to the sea.

With his Lady, he rules over all creatures and wonders of the deep. The Lady of the Waters of Life governs all rhythms and cycles of this realm: the ebb and flow of tides; the journey of a cloud's raindrop back to the sea, the return of the salmon to the source.

The Spindle speaks thus:

"I am Necessity. Always present, yet often ignored. Know that in me rests a source of deep joy."